

The worst thing I ever delegated.

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Executive Summary

Delegating sales (or any critical function you dislike) without staying hands-on alongside your manager is a trap — it doesn't eliminate the work, it delays and multiplies it when things inevitably collapse.

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The Delegation Trap: Hiring a Sales Manager 0:00

- At roughly **\$200K–\$300K/month**, most founders hire a sales manager
 - The assumption is that this hire will carry the business from ~\$300K to \$1M/month largely on their own
 - Tim Luong identifies this as the critical mistake he personally made
- Handing off sales entirely and stepping away does not work
 - The sales department is described as the **hardest department to stabilize** as you scale toward \$1M/month
 - Without founder involvement, systems don't get built correctly and blind spots go uncorrected

How to Stay Involved the Right Way 0:22

- The correct posture is **side-by-side**, not leading from the front or disappearing entirely
 - Stay involved at every step until the team collectively hits \$1M/month
- Specific involvement tasks the founder should continue doing:
 - Help the manager **build systems** and sign off on them before they go live
 - Help **catch blind spots** the new manager can't yet see
 - Help **drive the team's energy and accountability**
 - Continue showing up to **daily team meetings**
 - Keep doing **call reviews**
 - Hop on **one-on-ones with your best closers**
 - Ensure the sales manager is **firing underperforming closers** — don't let bad performers linger

- The goal is to delegate fast *while* building the infrastructure together, not delegate and disappear

The Universal Principle: Never Escape Your Most Important Function 0:45

- This lesson extends beyond sales — it applies to **whatever role or function you most want to hand off**
 - The thing you hate the most is almost always the thing you delegate first
 - But disliking a function doesn't make it less critical to the business
- Delegating something important without staying involved doesn't eliminate the work — it defers and amplifies it
 - Typical outcome: **3 months later**, you have to fire the manager and rebuild the entire department from scratch anyway
 - That is strictly more work than staying involved from the start

"Escaping the most important function of your business does not make it go away."

- Counterintuitive takeaway: **the role you're tempted to delegate because you don't enjoy it is probably the role you should stay in longer**
 - The challenge is to find ways to enjoy key pieces of it rather than avoiding it entirely
 - Sustainable delegation only works once stable systems exist and a capable leader has been developed with your involvement